



TEAM
Colorado Rockies

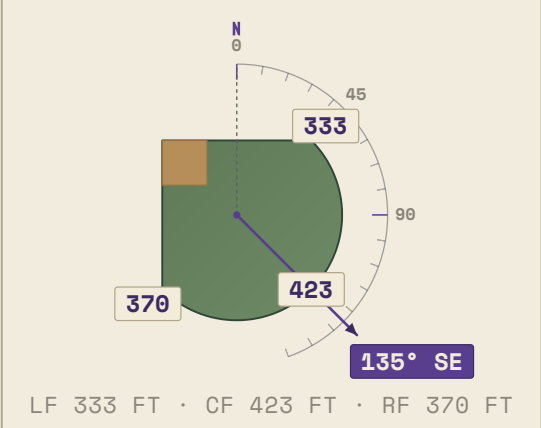
LEAGUE
National League

DIVISION
NL West

CLUB COLORS
 PURPLE  BLACK  SILVER

VISIT
NO. 16

CAPACITY	76,123 (76,000 opening)
SURFACE	Kentucky bluegrass (natural grass)
TYPE	Open-air multipurpose stadium adapted for MLB expansion
ARCHITECTURE	Utilitarian open-air multipurpose stadium with expandable movable-grandstand
FAÇADE	Concrete and steel grandstands with movable steel east-stand structure
ARCHITECT	Original Bears Stadium by local municipal designers; later expansions by several firms
NAME HISTORY	Bears Stadium (1948–1968); Mile High Stadium (1969–2001)
RENOVATIONS	Expanded repeatedly for football; movable east stands, upper decks, scoreboard, and event upgrades before Rockies tenancy
ADDRESS	2755 W 17th Avenue, Denver, CO 80204 (former site)
LOCATION	Urban-edge; Urban
SUCCEEDED BY	Coors Field



COST & FINANCING
\$500k \$7 million adj.
Publicly financed and expanded by Denver as a municipal stadium; Rockies tenancy used the existing facility as an interim Major League Baseball venue

1947
CONSTRUCTION BEGAN

1948
OPENED AS BEARS STADIUM

1960
BRONCOS BEGIN TENANCY

1968
RENAMED MILE HIGH STADIUM

1993
MLB PLAY BEGINS

1994
FINAL MLB GAME AUG 11

2000
LAST BRONCO GAME DEC 23

2002
DEMOLISHED

Mile High Stadium's place in MLB history is brief but revealing. It was not built to be the Rockies' permanent home; it was an adaptable open-air multipurpose stadium pressed into service while Denver proved it could support major-league baseball and while Coors Field was being built. That temporary role makes it different from most stadiums in the anthology. Its importance lies in transition rather than permanence.

The west-side urban-edge setting matched the building's regional function. Denver's new franchise needed a venue that could hold enormous crowds immediately, and Mile High already had the scale, access, and event infrastructure to do it. The stadium's expandable and movable-grandstand engineering, shaped largely by football and other uses, became a way to bridge the gap between expansion award and baseball-specific construction.

The bargain was straightforward. Mile High gave the Rockies significant capacity and instant legitimacy, but not a true baseball home. Its multipurpose, utilitarian form could adapt, but adaptation is not the same as belonging. Baseball there was provisional, staged inside a building whose history and geometry pointed elsewhere. That did not make the experience unimportant; it made it a public test of Denver's appetite for MLB.

Coors Field succeeded it in 1995 with a completely different argument: downtown, baseball-only, retro-classic, and designed around the rhythms of the new franchise rather than borrowed from another sport. Mile High Stadium matters because it captures the launch phase of expansion baseball. It shows that sometimes a temporary home is not a footnote but the proof of concept that makes the permanent ball-park possible.

II

HOME OPENER — FRIDAY, APRIL 9, 1993

OTHER VISITS: MULTIPLE

COLORADO ROCKIES VS MONTREAL EXPOS										Rockies 11, Expos 4			FINAL · 9 INNINGS · DAY GAME		
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	R	H	E			
MON	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	4	4	10	4			
COL	4	1	0	2	2	0	2	0	x	11	18	1			
ATTENDANCE 80,227	FIRST PITCH 3:05 PM MDT			GAME LENGTH 2:42			WINNING PITCHER Bryn Smith COL STARTER			LOSING PITCHER Kent Bottenfield MON STARTER					

WEATHER

 63° LIGHT DRIZZLE

 WIND 3 mph SW

 HUMIDITY 23%

